



Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



ABACUS Editorial

BLOOMING THROUGH WINTER: A FRESH VOW FOR VIBRANT GROWTH

Dear Statistics Incharges of BSG,

Thank you so much for all your sincere efforts throughout 2025 in taking care of each life and encouraging

members to the best of your ability. As the year comes to an end, we express our heartfelt gratitude to each one of you for your dedication, your hard work, and your unshakeable spirit.

Stepping into winter gently reminds of the crocuses – the quiet heralds of spring that bloom even through frozen ground. They do not wait for the warmth to arrive; they create it. Their gentle persistence reminds us that genuine hope is not dramatic – it is steady, patient, and unwavering. In the same way, each statistics incharge plays the role of a crocus within our organisation: making a fresh start, rising with quiet strength, bringing colour and connection while our individual challenges may feel like winter's frost.

Ikeda Sensei reminds us: *"To always start fresh, take on new challenges, and keep advancing as long as you live – that is the faith and way of life of Nichiren Buddhists. Therein lies vitality, joy, and happiness."* (NHR 28, Great Path, p. 164). With this guidance in our hearts, let us begin 2026 - *Year of Vibrant Growth for a Youthful Soka Gakkai Worldwide* with renewed resolve to achieve the

impossible and make it possible.

From now onwards, each of you, the statistics incharges must be at the forefront of realising our cherished goal of one million happy BSG members by 2030. The mission is clear:

- **Meet every new friend** with warmth – add them to BDS immediately, connect with them personally, teach them Gongyo and Daimoku, and help them experience the joy of faith.
- **Cherish each life** with the spirit of leaving no one behind.
- **Respond promptly** to every introduction request.
- **Strengthen heart-to-heart dialogue** and compassionate shakubuku.

Like the crocuses that bloom through winter, may each one of you persist with hope, stand firm in purpose, and illuminate every life that you encounter.

- **By ABACUS Editorial Team** ★★

ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

"A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today."

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)

BE AMBASSADORS OF SOKA

Helping Others Form Connections to Buddhism

Nichiren Daishonin writes: "I entrust you with the propagation of Buddhism in your province" (WND-1, 1117). When we are actively engaged in our communities, we can sow the seeds of happiness by helping many others form a connection to Buddhism.

As emissaries of the Buddha, our voices do the Buddha's work. Dialogue is also the heart of the Daishonin's ideal of "establishing the correct teaching for the peace of the land."

Interacting with many different kinds of people and engaging them in dialogue and discussion enables you to break out of your shell and develop a bigger state of life. Even if you may not be a very good speaker, there is no need to worry. Just keep challenging yourself positively. Talking to others about Buddhism is the shortest route for carrying out your human revolution.



Sincerely Promoting Understanding for Our Movement

Kosen-rufu is all about making friends.

In a number of his writings, Nichiren Daishonin cites the following passage from the Lotus Sutra: "Although the devil and the devil's people will be there, they will all protect the Buddhist Law" (LSOC6, 145). The aim of our effort to spread understanding for our movement is to turn even opponents into allies.

I hope that you, the members of the youth division, will speak with others confidently and frankly as fellow human beings, no matter who they may be. All you need to do is share your convictions in a polite, pleasant, unaffected, and natural manner.

Nothing makes a deeper impression than the sincerity of youth. Such sincerity will inspire trust and understanding.

(Extracted from SGI Newsletter No. 9150) ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

"With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu."



TRANSFORMING THE DISTRICT THROUGH DETERMINATION, DAIMOKU AND UNITY

Kareshma Khanna

***District Statistics Incharge
North India Area***



Scan to listen to
the experience

In 2022, when I was asked to become statistics incharge of Ashoka district, I reluctantly said yes. With a demanding job at a start-up, a four-month-old baby, and district responsibilities, I wondered how I could manage statistics too. I felt lost yet my heart said that if this opportunity appeared, my mentor must want me to accept it.

After COVID and district split, attendance in discussion meetings had dropped from 35-40 to just 16-17.

I took personal responsibility to revive the district. In May 2024, I went for a Gongyo & Tour meeting at the BSG HQ, and chanted name by name for each member.

As I made a determination to make Ashoka a region by 2030, obstacles appeared. Active members stopped coming, a new member who had enshrined the Gohonzon stopped practicing, attendance dipped to 10-11 and leadership became passive.

Through guidance I learnt - practice without guilt, cherish whoever comes, focus on raising leaders, and ensure joyful meetings. My prayers changed, and slowly our meetings became joyful. But soon I started taking statistics lightly - marking attendance was the only task I did sincerely. Then at the 2024 statistics incharges meeting, I was asked to present ABACUS. That opened a joyful new journey. I began reading the newsletter each month, participated in puzzles, and even won a few times.

In 2025, I renewed my determination and began a daimoku revolution - praying for smooth transfers, for leaders to emerge, and for victories in every member's life. But our attendance hit the lowest for May 2025 - just 16, leaving me defeated and anxious. Nichiren Daishonin says: **"Employ the strategy of the Lotus Sutra before any other"** (WND-1, The Strategy of the Lotus Sutra, p. 1001).

In July 2025, at the Mentor Memorial Hall training course, I renewed my prime point with Sensei and started seeking him in my daily practice. I realized that we were failing to meet our targets as we needed to be united. I realised: it is not my district, it is our district; not me taking 100 steps, but 100 of us taking one step together.

I reached out to active members, and together we prayed for VC subscriptions, members' health, active leadership, exam registrations, and welcoming new friends. We started chanting daily from 9-10 pm in alliance. In the past 3 months, we have

chanted over 5 million daimoku.

Personally, I began a 100-day challenge: two hours daimoku daily, reading the Goshō and NHR, encouraging one life every day, writing 600 names in my prayer book and doing over 120 home visits.

The district began to grow. We had 5 new introductions, 1 MD enshrined the Gohonzon and another WD applied for hers. Two YWDs inactive for 8 years became active and cleared the entrance exam. 3 members subscribed to Value Creation, including a WD absent for a year. Disconnected members reconnected and proactively took transfer to their new place of mission. Two WD leaders joined the Ashoka district and have taken full responsibility. One of our MDs received Bodhisattva in Action award, and several members have shared breakthroughs this year.

Personally, I have introduced 5 people this year, including my father and husband. After resigning 9 months ago and starting my own consultancy, I finally began receiving good projects. My father's property - vacant for 10 years, was rented on his terms. I curated Lucknow's first kids' exhibition, creating a new income stream.

I determine to stay united with my mentor, create unity and harmony wherever I go, and cherish each member on the BDS. I vow to make member care and shakubuku my only focus. ★★



Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the '**Discussion Meeting**' attendance in the month of November 2025.

*We accord these zones as '**MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH**' for November 2025.*

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda - Lotus
Noida City Centre
Noida West
Vaishali

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Lucknow
Lucknow - Gorakhpur
Mohali
Panchkula West

East India

Central Kolkata
Dumdum
Upper Assam

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka - Palam
Dwarka - Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikaspuri

Delhi - South

Badkal - Faridabad
CR Park - Kalkaji
Charmwood
Faridabad
Green Park
Lodhi Garden
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm
Saket
Sarita Vihar

South India

AP - Telangana (North)
Bangalore East
Bangalore South
Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Chennai Central
Chennai East

Delhi - North

Central Pitampura
Pusa

West India - 1

Andheri East
Goregaon Malad East
Koregaon - Airport
PCMC - Aundh
Powai
Pune South Hills
Thane - Kalyan

West India - 2

Bandra
Khar Santacruz BKC
Navi Mumbai
Sion Parel

MEETINGS IN DECEMBER 2025

7th December 2025
Student Division Meeting



Region Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

21st December 2025
Discussion Meeting



District Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!

Advancing toward the
“Year of Vibrant Growth for Youthful Soka Gakkai Worldwide,”
let us unite to strengthen and energize all our precious
comrades of Statistics Department.



We are excited to announce **area-wise BDS Training Courses** to be held across December 2025 and January 2026, aimed at fostering and empowering all Statistics Incharges. The training will primarily focus on how to use BDS as we advance towards our cherished goal of one million by 2030.

Stay tuned for the training date of your area!



HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

1 4 2 7 8 3



All India

2 8 9 6 4 0

(as of 10th Dec 2025)

Q. How do we keep the BDS updated?

Keeping the BDS updated is one of the most joyful and important responsibilities of a statistics incharge. An updated BDS ensures smooth communication, accurate reporting, and timely support to members and New Friends. Here are a few key points to remember:

1. Enter New Friend's details immediately

As soon as a New Friend attends a meeting, let's joyfully enter their details into the BDS right away in consultation with the introducer. Let's not wait for them to attend more meetings. This will help in timely follow-up and member care so that the New Friends can start practicing and savour the joy of faith.

2. Ensure all details are captured accurately

Let's double-check names, phone numbers, email IDs, and addresses of both the New Friend and the introducer. Correct information helps in reaching out to New Friends and their introducers.

3. Act promptly on introductions and transfers

Prompt action is the hallmark of a statistics incharge. Whenever there is an introduction or transfer request, let's process it immediately so that the member is smoothly connected to the right district.

4. Regularly update member milestones

Division graduations, Gohonzon conferrals, leaders' appointments, and any change in division or unit should be updated as soon as they occur. These updates ensure that the database reflects the member's correct information on the BDS which will help in planning the kosen-rufu activities.

5. Consistency is key

Let's make it a habit to check and update the BDS regularly. Even 5-10 minutes a day can ensure updated and correct data of the members on BDS.

*** Maintaining and updating the BDS will be covered in detail during the area-wise BDS Training Courses.*



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Nivedhya

Region Statistics Incharge, South India Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

I have been practicing for nine and a half years and became a statistics incharge in 2019 in Indore. When I was given this opportunity, the word "Statistics" honestly frightened me. I imagined a lot of numbers, systems, and technical processes.

I was really scared to pick it up. But the leaders at that time guided me patiently. I soon realised that this role was not just about numbers – it was about people's lives.

I was curious to understand every aspect of MDS. Hence, took support from leaders to clarify my doubts. Later, when I shifted to Bangalore, I was appointed region statistics incharge. Leaders here were prompt and active in responding to my queries. This made me self-reliant in handling the statistics.

By now, I had understood that statistics incharges are often the first ones to welcome new lives, whether through introductions or transfers. And now it was my responsibility to take care of these lives and respond to Sensei.

Till few years back, we did not have statistics incharges at every level. But today in 2025, we do. For me, this is a milestone etched in my heart.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

I was quite laid-back and tended to procrastinate a lot. But the statistics responsibility made me disciplined. I learned to prioritise and handled everything with sincerity, which helped me not only in practice but also in my work which involves analysing reports.

Initially, preparing reports, making PPTs, or using excel sheets felt very challenging . But as I went deeper into BDS – understanding active and inactive members, attendance percentages and membership trends, I began to see clearly where we were falling behind, how we needed to chant, and what problems needed to be addressed. This helped me adopt a more proactive, solution-driven mindset.

Gradually, I became confident in creating reports and maintaining database. These skills have helped me professionally as well.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

The transition from MDS to BDS has been very smooth. Statistics incharges have been able to make the best use of it. BDS is self-explanatory and user-friendly, and it makes fostering future statistics incharges easier from technical perspective.

The BSG Connect Plus mobile app

has also made things convenient. While not everyone in the region has started using it fully yet, but soon the time will come when everyone will be self-reliant and will mark attendance on the app independently .



Do you read the ABACUS regularly? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

I do read ABACUS regularly. Sometimes, I may skip a few pages, but overall, I enjoy it a lot. It is short, interesting and easy to engage with.

I hope we can create more awareness about the newsletter, as many members still don't know about it. We can have ABACUS reading time in discussion meeting just like we have VC Time.

I really enjoy the puzzle section, use it in district meetings and conduct activities based on it. ABACUS has helped me build a stronger study spirit. I especially like the experience section and often share it with the members and statistics incharges.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

Firstly, to stay in rhythm with every BSG campaign and find ways to re-activate inactive members based on daimoku.

Secondly, to foster existing newly appointed leaders so they develop a standalone spirit and connect deeply with Ikeda Sensei.

Thirdly, to conduct 100 dialogues and 30 shakubuku in 2026.

Lastly, to prove the validity of the law by overcoming every obstacle in my life and reporting victory to Sensei. ★★



Enter the **BDS Puzzle Zone!** Each MCQ is a clue on BDS processes and functions. Think carefully... only one option unlocks the right answer.

- 1. The appointment of a District Chief can be marked by the:**
 - a) Chapter Statistics Incharge
 - b) Region Statistics Incharge
 - c) Zone Statistics Incharge
 - d) Area Statistics Incharge and BDS Helpdesk
- 2. The requirements before marking an interaction in BDS are**
 - a) Approval from the Appointment Approving Committee
 - b) as in a) and Consent is submitted on mail by the leader recommended
 - c) Interaction must be recorded
 - d) An email is sent to BDS Helpdesk
- 3. For relocation to another country, Letter of Introduction (LOI) should be requested from BSG Headquarters –**
 - a) 1 week before travel
 - b) After arriving in the new country
 - c) Anytime within the year
 - d) At least 1 month in advance
- 4. When should an introduction request be raised?**
 - a) When the introducer and the new friend belong to the same district
 - b) as in a) but their blocks are different
 - c) Only when the new friend is in a different district from the introducer
 - d) Only when the introducer is a region chief and above
- 5. Who can mark the attendance of the entire district on the BSG Connect Plus mobile app?**
 - a) All members
 - b) Only those marked as District Statistics Incharge in BDS
 - c) All members and District Statistics Incharge
 - d) Only chapter leaders

6. From where can a member transfer be raised in BDS?

- a) Chapter statistics login
- b) Region statistics login
- c) District statistics login
- d) Area statistics login

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 31st December 2025

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

★ Sonia Jhington – West India 1 ★

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

1. FALSE - BDS was launched in November 2023
2. TRUE
3. FALSE - It can be marked by the chapter statistics incharge
4. FALSE - It can only be assigned to a chapter statistics incharge
5. FALSE - Only BDS Helpdesk can deactivate members
6. TRUE
7. TRUE
8. FALSE - The chapter statistics incharge with proxy rights can mark the attendance of the discussion meeting and Gosho meeting for that district
9. TRUE
10. FALSE - Future Division meetings attendance can only be marked on the BDS and not through the app



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to:
helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org
or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.



WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at :
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org